PARENT GUIDANCE · DESIGN SYSTEM

Foundations

Design guidelines · Parent Guidance · Updated October 15, 2026

Every value lives in `tokens.css` as a CSS variable (`--pg-navy`) and as a Tailwind class (`bg-pg-navy` , `text-pg-slate` …). In inline styles or `motion` props, use the variable: `style={{ boxShadow: "var(--pg-shadow-card)" }}` , `animate={{ backgroundColor: "var(--pg-teal)" }}` .

1.1 Palette

Brand

Token	Hex	Tailwind	Use
Navy	`#1c3243`	`pg-navy`	Headings, primary text, navigation, dark backgrounds, active chip
Navy hover	`#284054`	`pg-navy-hover`	Hover on navy elements
Slate	`#435766`	`pg-slate`	Body text, descriptions, interface icons
Teal	`#59797d`	`pg-teal`	**Action color**: Primary buttons, links, active icons, selection ring
Teal dark	`#406064`	`pg-teal-dark`	Hover/pressed for teal actions; small accent text (eyebrows, links, metadata)
Sage	`#90b3b6`	`pg-sage`	Decorative accent: color blocks, section-title side bar, large icons, search icons
Mist	`#acbcbe`	`pg-mist`	Decorative elements only ("•" separators with `aria-hidden` , inactive dots). **Never text**
Amber	`#c8893a`	`pg-amber`	Lesson accent; decorative fill only
Live	`#52bd95`	`pg-live`	"Live" dot; decorative only

Surfaces and borders

Token	Hex	Tailwind	Use
Cream	`#f9f4f1`	`pg-cream`	Default page background; search fields on white bars
Cream dark	`#f0edeb`	`pg-cream-dark`	Inactive chips, "Featured" button, dividers on cream
White	`#ffffff`	`white`	Cards, panels, filter bars, inputs
Tint	`#eaf1f1`	`pg-tint`	Soft surfaces: badges, date blocks, selected state

Token	Hex	Tailwind	Use
Tint soft	`#f0f6f6`	`pg-tint-soft`	Background of listing sections; row hover
Line	`#dee8e9`	`pg-line`	Borders of cards and inputs, dividers

In Figma these tokens have their own variable in *Semantic*: *Color Roles*: `pg-cream-dark` → **Background/Chip**, `pg-tint` → **Background/Tint**, `pg-tint-soft` → **Background/Tint Soft**, `pg-navy-hover` → **Background/Inverse Hover** and `pg-amber` → **Accent Colors/Amber** (each one aliases its primitive in *Primitive Colors*).

States

Used in badges, notices and validation. They meet AA on white and cream.

State	Text / icon	Soft background	Where it is used
Success	`#117a3a` `pg-success`	`#d3f7df` `pg-success-soft`	"Guide" badge (with navy text)
Warning	`#a84b02` `pg-warning`	`#feeab1` `pg-warning-soft`	"Worksheet" badge, Ask a Therapist legal notice
Error	`#932f2f` `pg-error`	`#fdcfcf` `pg-error-soft`	"Tool" badge, form errors

They match the Figma variables *Success / Warning / Error Colors* → *Contrast* (text) and → *Soft* (background). Each text color on its soft background passes AA (4.69:1 success, 4.8:1 warning, 5.58:1 error); the "Guide" badge keeps navy text and green for the icon.

Approved contrast combinations

Text	Background	Ratio	Allowed for
Navy	White / Cream / Tint / Line / Sage	5.9–13.2	Everything
Slate	White / Cream / Tint	6.6–7.5	Everything
Teal	White	4.7	Everything
Teal	Cream / Tint	4.1–4.3	**Only text ≥ 18px or ≥ 14px bold**; for small text use Teal dark
Teal dark	White / Cream / Tint	6.0–6.8	Everything
White	Teal / Teal dark / Navy	4.7 / 6.8 / 13.2	Everything (buttons, badges, dark blocks)
Sage	Navy	5.9	Secondary text and accents on dark backgrounds
~~Sage / Mist~~	~~White / Cream~~	2.0–2.3	**Never as text**
~~White~~	~~Sage~~	2.3	**Never**: on sage, text and badges are navy

Highlighted blocks

A banner or CTA **inside** a section must stand out from its background: `pg-sage` (navy text, Inverse button), `pg-navy` (white or sage text, Inverse button) or a white card with a `pg-line` border and the `card` shadow. Never `pg-tint` on `pg-tint-soft` or `pg-cream-dark` on `pg-cream` (1.04:1, the block disappears).

1.2 Typography

Poppins is the only typeface (400, 500, 600 and 700). It is applied once on `body` (`tokens.css`) and every element inherits it, including buttons and inputs: **do not add font classes**. No `font-black` or `font-light` either: Poppins is only loaded in 400–700.

Scale

Token	Mobile → desktop	Tailwind	Weight	Use
`display`	38 → 50px	`text-[38px] md:text-[50px]`	700	Main headline of **the home pages** (one per page)
`h1`	28 → 40px	`text-[28px] md:text-[40px]`	700 (500 in V2)	Page title; titles of featured sections with a colored background ("Need Help Now?", "Join Us!")
`h2`	24px	`text-2xl`	700	Section title, banners
`h3`	20px	`text-xl`	600–700	Block and panel titles, section labels with a sage bar ("Resource Library"), FAQ questions
`h4`	16px	`text-base`	700	Card title
`body-lg`	16px	`text-base`	400	Introductions and featured paragraphs
`body`	14px	`text-sm`	400	**Default text**, buttons, inputs
`small`	12px	`text-xs`	400–600	Metadata, captions, chips, field hints
`eyebrow`	11px	`text-[11px] uppercase`	600	Kicker above headings, date labels ("JUL")

Rules:

- **12px minimum**; 11px only for UPPERCASE text (eyebrows, months in date blocks).
- In Figma, uppercase text uses **Label/XSmall - Bold Caps** (11px, 15% tracking) or **Label/Small - SemiBold Caps** (12px, 10%), and quotes use **Body/Medium - Italic**. No component text is left without a style.
- In code, uppercase tracking comes from two tokens: `tracking-pg-caps` (0.15em, 11px text) and `tracking-pg-eyebrow` (0.1em, 12px and up). No one-off values (`tracking-[1.2px]` , `tracking-wider` …).
- No in-between sizes outside the scale (13, 15, 18, 22, 30, 36px…): use the nearest step.

- Brand emphasis in headlines: one word or phrase in teal *italics* ("Discover *Resources*…"), without changing the size.
- About 70 characters per line maximum in long paragraphs (`max-w-pg-reading` , 680px).

1.3 Spacing

Tailwind's 4px scale is used. Allowed steps:

Tailwind	px	Typical use
`1` / `1.5`	4 / 6	Icon ↔ small text
`2`	8	Gap between inline elements, icon ↔ label, between chips
`3`	12	Gap in compact lists and filter bars
`4`	16	Card padding, gap between fields
`5` / `6`	20 / 24	Panel padding, grid gap, mobile gutter
`8`	32	Space between blocks
`10` / `14`	40 / 56	Page side gutter (md / lg)
`14` / `16` / `20`	56 / 64 / 80	Section vertical padding

Use only values on the Spacing Scale (2, 4, 8, 12, 16, 20, 24, 32…). No half steps (`1.5` , `2.5` , `3.5`): they have no Figma token.

1.4 Radii

Token	Value	Tailwind	Use
`sm`	4px	`rounded-pg-sm`	Checkboxes, minimal elements
`md`	8px	`rounded-pg-md`	**Buttons**, inputs, selects, "Featured" button
`lg`	12px	`rounded-pg-lg`	Small panels, dropdown menus, date blocks
`xl`	16px	`rounded-pg-xl`	**Cards**, pop-ups, banners
`2xl`	28px	`rounded-pg-2xl`	Heroes, featured video, section blocks with a background
`full`	9999px	`rounded-full`	Chips, badges, avatars, dots, pill-shaped search bars

In the shadcn theme `rounded-lg` is 10px and `rounded-xl` 14px, so the `rounded-pg-*` tokens are always used.

1.5 Shadows

Every shadow is **navy-tinted** (`rgba(28,50,67,…)`), never black.

Token	Value	Use
`card`	`0 8px 24px rgba(28,50,67,0.06)`	Cards, filter bars, selected controls
`card-hover`	`0 8px 24px rgba(28,50,67,0.14)`	Interactive cards on hover; navbar on scroll
`overlay`	`0 24px 60px rgba(28,50,67,0.28)`	Pop-ups, modals, floating menus

Cards use a `pg-line` **border +** `card` **shadow**. To make something stand out, don't stack stronger shadows: use the background color (tint, sage or navy).

1.6 Icons

- Library: **Material Icons, Outlined style** (`@mui/icons-material`). Other styles (Filled, Rounded, Sharp) and other libraries are not mixed in.
- Always import from `src/components/ui/icons.tsx`, never straight from `@mui/icons-material`: `import { Search } from "./components/icons"`. If an icon is missing, add it there using its `…Outlined` version.
- Size with `size` in px: 14–16px in controls and 18–20px in icon-only buttons (`<Search size={16} aria-hidden="true" />`).
- Color via `currentColor` plus a text class (`text-pg-slate`, `text-pg-sage` …), never a hex in the SVG.
- Decorative icons get `aria-hidden="true"` ; icon-only buttons get an `aria-label`.
- Exception: SVG logos (Parent Guidance, partners, social networks) keep their brand colors.